

MERIDIAN & ASSOCIATES LLP

Advisory | Assurance | Tax | Consulting

Management Team Bios

Senior Manager & Manager Profiles

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1. David Kim, PMP, SAP Certified

Senior Manager, ERP Implementation

Years of Experience: 14 years

Office: Chicago, IL

Email: d.kim@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

David Kim is a Senior Manager in Meridian's Technology Consulting practice, specializing in large-scale ERP implementations with a focus on SAP S/4HANA. Over his 14-year career, David has delivered 11 full-lifecycle ERP implementations across manufacturing, retail, and financial services industries. He is recognized for his expertise in managing complex, multi-workstream programs involving cross-functional teams of 40-80 consultants and navigating the organizational change management challenges that frequently derail ERP projects.

David leads a team of 28 consultants and is responsible for \$12 million in annual engagement revenue. His project delivery track record includes a 100% go-live success rate and an average budget variance of less than 5%. He is a certified SAP S/4HANA Solution Architect and has completed advanced training in SAP Activate methodology, Agile at Scale (SAFe), and organizational change management.

Education

- MS, Information Systems, Carnegie Mellon University (2014)
- BS, Industrial Engineering, Purdue University (2012)

Certifications

- Project Management Professional (PMP)
- SAP Certified Application Associate - SAP S/4HANA (multiple modules)
- SAFe 5 Agilist (SA)
- ITIL v4 Foundation
- Prosci Certified Change Practitioner

Technical Specializations

- SAP S/4HANA implementation (Finance, MM, PP, SD, WM modules)
- Data migration strategy and execution (SAP LSMW, BODS, Syniti)
- Integration architecture (SAP CPI, MuleSoft, Dell Boomi)
- Cutover planning and hypercare management
- SAP BTP (Business Technology Platform) and Fiori UX design

Project Highlights

- **Fortune 200 Manufacturer:** Program Manager for 16-month SAP S/4HANA greenfield implementation across 8 distribution centers. Managed 65-person cross-functional team. Delivered on-time, 3% under budget.
- **National Retail Chain:** Led SAP S/4HANA conversion from ECC 6.0 for 340-store retailer. Coordinated data

migration of 12M+ material master records and 8 years of transactional history. Zero critical defects at go-live.

- **Mid-Market Pharmaceutical Company:** Directed end-to-end SAP implementation covering Finance, Quality Management, and Batch Management. Achieved FDA 21 CFR Part 11 compliance validation on first attempt.

Team Leadership

David directly manages a team of 28 consultants ranging from Analyst to Manager level. He serves as the practice's recruiting lead for campus hires from target universities and has designed the SAP Academy internal training curriculum, which has upskilled over 60 consultants since its launch in 2022. David also mentors four junior managers in the firm's formal mentorship program.

2. Rachel Okonkwo, CPA, MST

Manager, Tax Provision

Years of Experience: 9 years

Office: New York, NY

Email: r.okonkwo@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Rachel Okonkwo is a Manager in Meridian's Tax Practice, focusing on ASC 740 income tax provision and compliance for multinational corporations. Over her 9-year career, Rachel has served clients across technology, financial services, and consumer products industries, managing tax provision engagements for companies with revenues ranging from \$500 million to \$45 billion. She is known for her technical depth in complex areas including uncertain tax positions (FIN 48), transfer pricing implications for provision, and tax reform impact analysis.

Rachel manages a team of 12 tax professionals and is responsible for the timely delivery of quarterly and annual tax provisions for 8 key client relationships. She has been instrumental in the firm's adoption of tax technology tools, leading the implementation of Thomson Reuters ONESOURCE Tax Provision for three major clients and developing automated workpapers that have reduced provision cycle time by 35% on average.

Education

- MS, Taxation (MST), New York University School of Law (2019)
- BS, Accounting, summa cum laude, Howard University (2017)

Certifications

- Certified Public Accountant (CPA), State of New York
- Certified Tax Technologist (CTT), Thomson Reuters
- Member, American Institute of CPAs (AICPA) - Tax Section
- Member, Tax Executives Institute (TEI)

Technical Specializations

- ASC 740 income tax provision (quarterly and annual)
- Uncertain tax positions (FIN 48/ASC 740-10)
- International tax provision (GILTI, BEAT, FDII, Pillar Two)
- Tax technology implementation (ONESOURCE, Corptax, Longview)
- Tax accounting methods and R&D credit documentation

Project Highlights

- **Global Technology Company:** Led ASC 740 provision for \$28B revenue multinational with operations in 40+ jurisdictions. Managed complex Pillar Two impact analysis and implemented ONESOURCE Tax Provision, reducing quarterly close cycle from 18 days to 11 days.
- **Fortune 500 Financial Services Firm:** Directed tax reform impact analysis (TCJA and subsequent guidance)

covering \$3.2B in deferred tax assets. Presented findings to Audit Committee and external auditors.

- **Consumer Products Conglomerate:** Managed annual and quarterly provisions across 6 domestic and 22 international entities. Identified \$14M in previously unrecognized tax benefits through comprehensive FIN 48 review.

Team Leadership

Rachel leads a team of 12 tax professionals including 3 seniors and 9 staff/associates. She has been recognized as a top mentor in the firm's New Professional Development program for two consecutive years and serves on the Tax Practice's Diversity, Equity & Inclusion steering committee. Rachel is also the lead instructor for the firm's internal ASC 740 training curriculum.

3. Alex Petrov, CISSP, CISM, CEH

Senior Manager, Cybersecurity

Years of Experience: 13 years

Office: Washington, D.C.

Email: a.petrov@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Alex Petrov is a Senior Manager in Meridian's Cybersecurity & Privacy Practice, leading the firm's offensive security, incident response, and security architecture service lines. With 13 years of experience spanning the US intelligence community, a leading cybersecurity firm, and professional services, Alex brings a rare combination of adversarial mindset and enterprise governance expertise. He has led over 200 penetration testing engagements, managed incident response for 15 major breaches, and designed security architectures for organizations protecting critical infrastructure across government and private sectors.

Alex manages a team of 22 cybersecurity professionals and oversees \$9.5 million in annual engagement revenue. His team maintains a 98% client satisfaction rating and has been instrumental in building Meridian's reputation as a top-tier cybersecurity advisory practice. Alex holds an active TS/SCI security clearance and regularly advises clients in the defense industrial base and federal government sectors.

Education

- MS, Cybersecurity, Georgia Institute of Technology (2016)
- BS, Computer Science, Virginia Tech (2013)

Certifications

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- Certified Information Security Manager (CISM)
- Certified Ethical Hacker (CEH)
- GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH)
- AWS Security Specialty Certification
- Active TS/SCI Security Clearance

Technical Specializations

- Offensive security and penetration testing (network, application, cloud)
- Incident response and digital forensics
- Zero-trust architecture design and implementation
- Cloud security posture management (AWS, Azure, GCP)
- CMMC/NIST SP 800-171 compliance for defense industrial base
- Security operations center (SOC) design and optimization

Project Highlights

- **Federal Civilian Agency:** Led FedRAMP High authorization assessment for agency's enterprise cloud migration

(1,800 applications on Azure Government). Zero findings on initial assessment. Developed continuous monitoring program.

- **Global Financial Institution:** Directed incident response for sophisticated nation-state attack affecting 2.3M customer records. Contained breach within 48 hours, led forensic investigation, and managed regulatory disclosure across 6 jurisdictions.
- **Defense Contractor:** Designed and implemented zero-trust architecture across 45,000 endpoints, achieving CMMC Level 3 certification. Reduced attack surface by 72% and MTTD from 96 hours to 6 hours.

Team Leadership

Alex leads a diverse team of 22 cybersecurity professionals including red team operators, incident responders, security architects, and GRC analysts. He has established the firm's Cybersecurity Analyst Development Program (CADP), a 12-month rotational program that has trained 35 entry-level analysts since its inception in 2021. Alex also serves as the firm's internal CISO advisor, providing guidance on Meridian's own security posture.

4. Maria Santos, CPA, CIA

Manager, Audit & Assurance

Years of Experience: 8 years

Office: San Francisco, CA

Email: m.santos@meridian-llp.com

Professional Summary

Maria Santos is a Manager in Meridian's Audit & Assurance Practice, specializing in technology and life sciences company audits. Over her 8-year career, Maria has served as engagement manager for audits of public and private companies ranging from pre-IPO startups to \$15 billion revenue technology firms. She has particular expertise in revenue recognition (ASC 606), stock-based compensation accounting (ASC 718), and business combinations (ASC 805), making her a valuable resource for high-growth technology companies navigating complex accounting issues.

Maria manages a team of 15 audit professionals and oversees 6 key audit engagements annually. She has been recognized with Meridian's 'Rising Leader' award in 2024 for her contributions to practice development, including the design of the firm's technology industry audit methodology and her leadership of the audit analytics initiative, which integrates data analytics and continuous auditing techniques into standard audit procedures.

Education

- MS, Accountancy, University of Southern California (2018)
- BA, Economics, University of California, Berkeley (2016)

Certifications

- Certified Public Accountant (CPA), State of California
- Certified Internal Auditor (CIA)
- Certified in Risk Management Assurance (CRMA)
- Member, AICPA - Auditing Standards Board Observer Program

Technical Specializations

- Technology and SaaS company audits (public and private)
- Revenue recognition (ASC 606) for complex arrangements
- Stock-based compensation (ASC 718) and equity accounting
- Business combinations and purchase price allocation (ASC 805)
- SOC 1/SOC 2 examination and IT general controls testing
- Audit data analytics and continuous auditing methodologies

Project Highlights

- **Pre-IPO SaaS Company:** Managed first-year audit for \$2.1B revenue SaaS company preparing for IPO. Navigated complex ASC 606 implementation for multi-element arrangements and stock-based compensation restatement. Achieved clean opinion with no material adjustments.
- **Fortune 500 Technology Company:** Led integrated audit (financial statements and ICFR) for \$15B revenue

technology firm. Managed team of 35 auditors across 4 locations. Identified and resolved 3 significant deficiencies before year-end.

- **Biotech Startup Portfolio:** Managed audits for 4 pre-revenue biotechnology companies, addressing complex R&D cost capitalization, in-process R&D valuation, and going concern assessments. All opinions issued within 60 days of year-end.

Team Leadership

Maria directly supervises a team of 15 audit professionals and serves as counselor to 8 staff in the firm's performance management system. She is the San Francisco office's campus recruiting lead for UC Berkeley and Stanford, and she co-chairs the firm's Women in Leadership employee resource group. Maria has also developed and delivered the firm's internal training module on ASC 606 revenue recognition, which has been completed by over 200 audit professionals firm-wide.